

## The Indus River

The Indus River is one of the longest rivers in Asia, flowing through China, India and Pakistan. It rises in Tibet near Lake Mansarovar and flows about 3,180 kilometres before emptying into the Arabian Sea near Karachi.

The river is the lifeline of Pakistan's agriculture. The Indus Valley Civilization, one of the world's earliest urban cultures, flourished along its banks around 2500 BCE, with major cities at Mohenjo-daro and Harappa.

Major tributaries include the Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas and Sutlej rivers, which join the Indus in Punjab.

## The Indus Waters Treaty

In 1960, India and Pakistan signed the Indus Waters Treaty, brokered by the World Bank. The treaty allocates the three eastern rivers (Ravi, Beas, Sutlej) to India and the three western rivers (Indus, Jhelum, Chenab) to Pakistan.

The treaty has survived multiple wars and is often cited as one of the most successful water-sharing agreements in the world.